



Tandy Corporation

News Release

For Immediate Release

March 28, 1988

Ed Juge
Director, Market Planning
(817) 390-3549

TC-88-027

**TANDY CORPORATION ANNOUNCES PLANS TO LICENSE
DESKMATE AS OPERATING ENVIRONMENT**

BERKELEY, Calif.--Tandy Corporation announced today that it will license its DeskMate[®] interface to developers as an affordable graphics interface for PC-compatible personal computers. The announcement, made at the annual Software Publisher's Association conference, represents the company's commitment to bringing ease-of-use to low-cost personal computers in the home and business markets.

DeskMate is the best-suited graphics-oriented interface suitable for 8088, 8086 and low end 80286-based computers and requires only 384 kilobytes of memory. It is compatible with industry-standard MS-DOS[®] machines, including portables, and supports standard video modes such as CGA, EGA, Tandy[®] 1000 and Hercules. DeskMate also provides workgroup functionality through RS-232 or any NetBIOS-based network, such as 3Com[®] or TandyLink[™].

--More--

There are more widely accepted personal computer applications available for MS-DOS than for any other PC operating system. Tandy and participating software developers feel the introduction of a common graphical interface for lower cost computers should provide a new ease-of-use and a more attractive option for many PC buyers.

As an operating environment, DeskMate brings a common interface to diverse application programs through a standard set of pull-down menus and pop-up dialog boxes.

"Tandy continues to stress compatibility in both the software and hardware arena," said Dr. Scott Cutler, vice president, Software Design, Tandy Electronics. In order to further this goal, applications developed under the DeskMate environment will have a common look and feel. Ease of use is significantly enhanced when a common set of functions and commands exist from application to application."

The DeskMate interface will bring a commonality of keyboard and mouse commands to diverse applications which in turn will significantly reduce the learning time required for each new software package.

A number of software publishers who agree with this philosophy have already committed to provide programs that run under the DeskMate environment. These companies include Activision, Broderbund, Electronic Arts, First Byte, Intuit, The Learning Company, Sierra Online, Software Publishing Corporation and Symantec.

--More--

Tandy licenses DeskMate interface
Page Three

"The significance of our DeskMate interface strategy," concluded Cutler, "is that it provides users of low-cost personal computers a degree of simplicity and user friendliness previously available only on more expensive computer systems."

--30--

DeskMate and Tandy are registered trademarks of Tandy Corporation.
TandyLink is a trademark of Tandy Corporation.
MS-DOS is a registered trademark of Microsoft Corporation.
3Com is a registered trademark of 3Com Corporation.